

BESTIARY

Friendly creatures, gentle problems, and encounter ideas



THISTLEBRIGHT ADVENTURES

Scottish fairy myth, high fantasy, safe wonder, and table rules made for brave young players.

How to Use Creatures

In Thistlebright, a creature is a story moment. It might be scared, proud, hungry, lonely, sleepy, or confused. Heroes are encouraged to notice feelings first.



Creature rule: give it a feeling, a wish, and one funny complication before you think about danger.

Entry format: What it feels, what it wants, how it helps, and what makes the scene funny or tricky.

- Use creatures as friends, messengers, puzzles, guardians, or comic interruptions.
- For this age, avoid “kill it” goals. Use helping, calming, racing, finding, sharing, or promising.
- If a creature is dangerous, make the danger environmental: slippery bank, loud roar, storm cloud, falling pine cones.

Creature role	At the table
Friend	Offers help after kindness.
Guardian	Asks for a promise or proof.
Mystery	Acts strangely because it is worried.
Comic trouble	Makes a safe mess that changes the scene.

LOCH AND GLEN CREATURES

Moon-Kelpie Foal

Feels: Lonely and nervous.

Wants: Its moon-bell returned.

Helps by: Carries one hero safely across shallow water.

Complication: Splashes the map when startled.

Gentle approach: notice the feeling, offer one kind thing, then roll only if the creature is still unsure.

Brave

Kind

Quick

Pick one depending on the child's idea.

Thistle Sprite

Feels: Proud and tiny.

Wants: Someone to admire its thorn crown.

Helps by: Shows a hidden fairy path.

Complication: Gets offended by rude pointing.

Gentle approach: notice the feeling, offer one kind thing, then roll only if the creature is still unsure.

Brave

Kind

Quick

Pick one depending on the child's idea.

Moss Troll Napper

Feels: Sleepy and warm-hearted.

Wants: A quieter place to nap.

Helps by: Lifts a log bridge.

Complication: Snores bubbles that float away clues.

Gentle approach: notice the feeling, offer one kind thing, then roll only if the creature is still unsure.

Brave

Kind

Quick

Pick one depending on the child's idea.

Silver Fox Familiar

Feels: Curious and polite.

Wants: A riddle answered.

Helps by: Leads heroes to tracks.

Complication: Only speaks in compliments.

Gentle approach: notice the feeling, offer one kind thing, then roll only if the creature is still unsure.

Brave

Kind

Quick

Pick one depending on the child's idea.



CREATURE SCENES

Use the picture first: what does the child notice, who looks worried, and what helpful thing might the heroes try?

FOREST AND SKY CREATURES

Rowan Owl

Feels: Wise but forgetful.

Wants: Help remembering a name.

Helps by: Sees through mist.

Complication: Calls everyone “young acorn”.

Scene seed: it appears while the heroes are already trying to help someone else.

Best first move ask what the creature feels.

Heather Hare

Feels: Fast and worried.

Wants: Its red ribbon untangled.

Helps by: Carries a message.

Complication: Keeps changing direction.

Scene seed: it appears while the heroes are already trying to help someone else.

Best first move ask what the creature feels.

Teacup Dragon

Feels: Hot-tempered but small.

Wants: A biscuit and apology.

Helps by: Boils water for tea or steam clues.

Complication: Sneezes sparks into puddles.

Scene seed: it appears while the heroes are already trying to help someone else.

Best first move ask what the creature feels.

Loch Lantern Jelly

Feels: Shy and glowing.

Wants: A dark pool made less lonely.

Helps by: Lights underwater steps.

Complication: Floats away if shouted at.

Scene seed: it appears while the heroes are already trying to help someone else.

Best first move ask what the creature feels.

TINY ODD CREATURES

Bog-Boot Brownie

Feels: Helpful and muddy.

Wants: A pair of boots to clean.

Helps by: Finds footprints.

Complication: Cleans the wrong thing first.

Cloud Sheep

Feels: Dreamy and soft.

Wants: A shepherd star.

Helps by: Makes a fluffy bridge.

Complication: Drifts when children giggle.

Make your own: choose an animal, add a fairy object, then give it one feeling and one wish.

CREATURE BUILDER

Roll	Animal	Fairy twist	Feeling
1	Fox	silver whiskers	worried
2	Hare	bell tail	excited
3	Owl	moon glasses	sleepy
4	Pony	kelp mane	lonely
5	Dragon	teacup size	proud
6	Sheep	cloud wool	confused

Example: Roll 4, 2, 1: a pony with a bell tail who is worried. It lost the bell that tells the loch when to sleep.

Finish the entry

Add one line for what the creature wants, one line for how it helps, and one safe complication.

Make it child-friendly

Replace defeat with help, chase, song, puzzle, promise, snack, or finding a lost thing.

Quick stat choice

Brave for scary noises, Kind for feelings, Quick for movement or noticing.

Reward idea

A friend, clue, safe path, tiny charm, bedtime-song note, or funny drawing prompt.